

HYDERABAD | The Big Move



Konijeti Rosaiah is getting ready to shuffle his ministry soon after moving into Camp Office, the official residence of the chief minister. The shuffle will be announced in early April, more than seven months after Rosaiah took charge following his predecessor Y.S. Rajasekhara Reddy's death. The inclu-

ROSAIAH (CENTRE) AT CAMP OFFICE

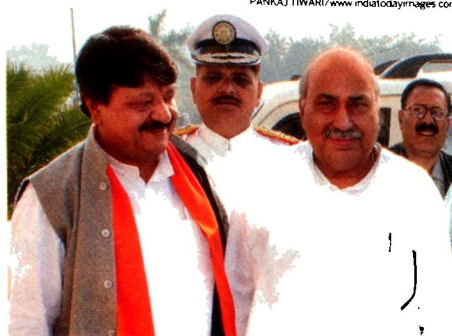
sion of Reddy's widow Vijayalakshmi, who was elected unopposed in a bypoll, is certain. This means that their son Congress MP Jaganmohan Reddy will have to wait in the wings for a little longer. This after he has buried the hatchet and is now dutifully doing the rounds of the state's districts. Rosaiah also plans to drop a few Reddy loyalists from the ministry and is in no mood to mollify them. Falling in line following Rosaiah's diktat after the initial convulsions following YSR's death has obviously not helped them much. Rosaiah is contemplating raising the strength of the ministry to 45 from 34. At last, it seems, YSR's successor is ready to crack the whip. **by Amarnath K. Menon**

BUZZ OF THE WEEK

Mamata Banerjee is so busy plotting the ouster of the CPIM) in Kolkata that she skipped a meeting convened by the prime minister last week to discuss infrastructure related matters with senior Planning Commission officials.

BHOPAL | Upped Ante

After the Women's Reservation Bill was passed in the Rajya Sabha, the idea of a Legislative Council has suddenly caught the imagination of BJP leaders in Madhya Pradesh. While the party has so far opposed the idea, prospects of a radically altered scenario with one-third seats for women has forced the party's legislative wing into a rethink. Heavyweights such as assembly speaker, Ishwardas Rohani, Commerce and Industry Minister Kailash Vijayvargiya, and Law and Legislative Affairs Minister Narottam Mishra favour the move. With the Congress already in favour of the idea, bi-partisan support for a Legislative Council seems to have emerged. With the Assembly passing a



VIJAYVARGIYA (LEFT) WITH ROHANI

unanimous resolution for simultaneous holding of assembly and parliamentary elections, there is now an outburst of bonhomie between the treasury and opposition benches to ensure easy passage of a bill to create a Legislative Council in the state, provided the BJP sheds its inhibitions. **by Ambresh Mishra**

PUNJAB | Case and Tell

The state Assembly has come up with a rather strange proposal. Its theme: 'Let's forgive and forget'. Speaker Nirmaljit Singh Kahlon read out a letter from Deputy Speaker Satpal Gosain which said the Assembly should pass a resolution withdrawing all court cases against MLAs to improve relations between them after vendetta cases are done



away with. Legal luminaries debated whether the Assembly has such power and, if so, whether it will be ethical to pass the proposal. With cases registered against Chief Minister Parkash Singh Badal, Deputy Chief Minister Sukhbir Badal, Speaker Kahlon and former chief minister Amarinder Singh among many others, the move has led to an unwilling admission that the lodging of such cases is prompted mostly by vendetta. **by Arvind Chhabra**